

MEDPOL-GLP1-v3: GLP-1 Receptor Agonists for Weight Management

BlueSun Health Medical Policy

Policy Number: MEDPOL-GLP1-v3

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Reviewed: December 15, 2025

SCOPE: This policy governs coverage of glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonists (semaglutide, liraglutide, tirzepatide) when prescribed for weight management in adult members.

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA. All of the following must be met and documented in the medical record:

1. Age at least 18 years.
2. Body Mass Index (BMI) at or above 30 kg/m², OR BMI at or above 27 kg/m² with at least one weight-related comorbidity (hypertension, type 2 diabetes mellitus, dyslipidemia, or obstructive sleep apnea).
3. Documented participation in a supervised program of reduced-calorie diet, increased physical activity, and behavior modification for a minimum of six months with objective measures of compliance.
4. Absence of contraindications, specifically: personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma; personal history of multiple endocrine neoplasia type 2; pregnancy or active plans for pregnancy.

STEP THERAPY REQUIREMENT: Before approval of tirzepatide or the obesity-specific formulations of semaglutide, members must have a documented trial and inadequate response to at least one generic or preferred alternative pharmacotherapy, unless clinically contraindicated.

REAUTHORIZATION: Approvals are granted for 6 months. Continued coverage requires documented weight loss of at least 5% of baseline body weight.